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MILITARY SPECIFICATION

IGNITER MARK 125 MOD 4

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1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers only one type of igniter used in rocket motors. Included herein are general and specific safety precautions, together with advisory procedures, to be observed while assembling, loading, and handling.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS, STANDARDS, DRAWINGS, AND OTHER PUBLICATIONS

2.1 The following specifications, standards, drawings and other publications, of the issue in effect on the date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification.

SPECIFICATIONS

All specifications listed on Bureau of Ordnance List of Drawings, LD 268441.

STANDARDS

All standards listed on Bureau of Ordnance List of Drawings, LD 268441. In addition, the following standard is applicable:

Military

MIL-STD-129 Marking of Shipments

DRAWINGS

All drawings listed on Bureau of Ordnance List of Drawings, LD 268441.

(Copies of specifications, standards, and drawings required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring agency or as directed by the contracting officer).

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2.2 Other Publications. —The following publications, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids, unless otherwise stated, form a part of this specification:

INTERSTATE COMMERCE COMMISSION REGULATIONS

Regulations for Transportation of Explosives and Other Dangerous Articles, etc.

(Information as to the availability of these Regulations may be obtained from the Interstate Commerce Commission, Washington 25, D.C.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 General Requirements

3.1.1 Materials. —See OP 400, para. 3.2.

3.1.2 Gages. —See OP 400, para. 4.5.1.

3.1.3 Finish. —Parts, components, and assemblies shall be manufactured and finished in accordance with the pertinent Bureau of Ordnance drawings.

3.1.4 Interchangeability. —Parts shall be capable of interchangeable assembly without interference, binding, or misalignment.

3.2 Detail Requirements

3.2.1 Components, Subassemblies and Parts. —The components of the igniter shall be considered in two categories, inert and explosive.

3.2.1.1 Inert Components of Igniter. —The inert components shall consist of the following subassemblies and parts:

BuOrd Dwg No.	Title
457892	Plug
457895	Case
457894	Insulated Terminal
457889	Cover

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(cont)

BuOrd Dwg No.	Title
457893	Case Subassembly
457891	Case Assembly
1127337	Insulating Sleeve (1/2")
1127334	Insulating Sleeve (1 1/2")

3.2.1.1.1 Case Subassembly. -This subassembly operation consists of inserting the insulated terminal through the case from the inside and soldering in place. The soldering must be of such quality that, in later testing with an internal air pressure of 5 psi, it shall not leak.

3.2.1.1.2 Case Assembly. -The case assembly operation consists of inserting the plug into the case subassembly so that the flanged portion is external to the case. The lip, internal to the case, is then expanded so that the plug will blow out under an air pressure of 50 through 100 psi. The seal between the plug and the case must be of such quality that it shall not leak when subjected to an internal pressure of 5 psi. An approved sealing compound may be used to assist in meeting this airtight requirement.

3.2.1.2 Explosive Components of Igniter. -The explosive components of the igniter shall consist of the following assemblies and parts:

BuOrd Dwg No.	Title
656714	Squib Mk 1 Mod 0
457784	Igniter Charge
457890	Igniter Case and Squib Assembly
457888	Igniter Mk 125 Mod 4 (Loaded Assembly)

3.2.1.2.1 Squib. -The Squib Mk 1 Mod 0 prior to use in this igniter shall have met the requirements of MIL-S-17923-(NOrd).

3.2.1.2.2 Charge. -The charge shall consist of the proper ratio by weight of FFFG black powder and coated magnesium powder evenly blended.

2.3.1.2.3 Igniter Case and Squib Assembly. -The case and squib assembly operation consists of threading the bared squib leads through the tubes of the insulated terminal and soldering the leads to the tubes.

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The soldering, which may be performed at either the inboard or outboard ends of the tubes, must provide an airtight seal when tested with an air pressure of 2 to 5 psi applied from inside the case. Care should be taken to insure that no solder bridge is formed between the terminal tubes. The inboard surfaces of the insulated terminal, bared squib leads, and the adjacent case surfaces should be coated with an approved insulating compound to provide an electrical short-to-ground resistance of a least 50,000 ohms for the loaded igniter. The insulating compound applied in this assembly shall be thoroughly dry (not tacky) before proceeding with the case loading and closing operations. The insulating sleeves are assembled over the lead wires and the external ends of the terminal tubes. At this point a suitable shorting device shall be applied to the bare ends of the lead wires. An approved insulating compound is applied to cover the joint between the insulated terminal and the insulating tubes.

3.2.1.2.4 Igniter Loading. -The igniter loading operation consists of placing sufficient (approximately 10 grams) igniter charge in the case and squib assembly so that suitable compaction of the charge will be obtained when the igniter is seamed (See 4.3.3). The igniter charge is leveled, the cover placed on the case and held to the loaded case with approximately 50 pounds load while the cover is seamed to the case. No powder grains should be present at the contact surfaces of cover and case. The squib leads are shorted and a lacquer coating applied to the entire assembly to a point just beyond the end of the insulated terminal but not above the 1/2 inch insulating sleeve.

3.2.1.2.5 Igniter Assembly. -The completed igniter assembly shall not evidence on any external surface, any trace of explosive composition or extraneous material affecting use, safety or appearance, not withstanding desensitization of such materials effected by final coating materials.

3.3 Performance Requirements

3.3.1 Electrical Continuity and Resistance Test. -The electrical circuit of the igniter between the lead wires shall be continuous and within the resistance limits of 0.70 and 1.30 ohms inclusive. The resistance between the connected lead wires and any portion of the bare metal of the igniter case or cover shall be not less than 50,000 ohms (See 4.3.1).

3.3.2 Air Tightness Test. -Assembled igniters shall be tight against air leakage at normal room temperature 70°F ± 10° when tested under conditions described in 4.3.2.

3.3.3 Vibration Test. -After the igniters have been subjected to conditions simulating those encountered in transporation and service

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handling (See 4.3.2.1) they shall be airtight, have proper electrical continuity, and shall function when energized by a d.c. firing current of 1.5 ± 0.15 amperes at normal room temperature.

3.3.4 Igniter Functioning.—The igniters, when subjected to a d.c. firing current of 1.5 ± 0.15 amperes at normal room temperature, shall function with an upper limit of 22 milliseconds. See 4.3.2.3 and NAVORD OSTD 80.

3.3.5 Ballistic Performance.—The igniter, when assembled in either standard-service or static-firing type rocket motors, shall produce the proper ignition of the rocket propellant without misfires, hangfires, or other evidence of malfunction directly attributable to the igniter when fired under the test conditions of 4.3.2.5.

3.4 Workmanship.—Parts, components, and assemblies shall be manufactured and finished in accordance with best commercial practices governing end quantity production of analogous parts maintaining the dimensions, finishes, and tolerances specified herein and in the applicable Bureau of Ordnance drawings. Soldering, wiring, loading, assembling and other factors affecting the appearance or function of the completed assembly shall be neat and thorough.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Sampling

4.1.1 Sampling Method.—The Government Inspector will use sampling plans and procedures when applicable, in the determination of acceptability of lots of products, procured by the Government, and which, unless otherwise specified, shall conform to the provisions of MIL-STD-105. (See 4.3.2)

4.1.2 Lots.—The term "lot" shall mean "inspection lot", i.e., a collection of units of product submitted by a supplier for government inspection. Except as specified in 4.1.4.2, the number of units of product in inspection lots shall be determined by the government inspector in accordance with applicable procedures and may differ from the quantity designated in the contract or order as a lot for production, shipment, or other purpose.

4.1.3 Preliminary Lot.—Unless otherwise directed by the Bureau of Ordnance, the contractor shall, before beginning production under

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any contract, order, or requisition, submit a preliminary lot of unassembled parts and complete igniter assemblies for inspection, loading, and testing for compliance with all requirements of this specification at an activity to be designated by the Bureau of Ordnance. The preliminary lot shall consist of the following items:

(a) One hundred sets of all parts, unassembled, including squibs, but excluding the igniter charges, as listed on Bureau of Ordnance List of Drawings, LD 268441.

(b) One hundred igniter case and squib assemblies in accordance with BuOrd Dwg 457890 together with one hundred covers, BuOrd Dwg 457899.

(c) Five hundred complete igniter assemblies, in accordance with BuOrd Dwg 457888.

All items submitted as the preliminary lot shall be manufactured in general accordance with the procedures proposed for use in execution of the contract, order, or requisition. In this instance, however, the contractor will not be required to employ all of the special tools, jigs, fixtures, gages etc., intended to be used in full quantity production.

4.1.3.1 Loading and Testing of Preliminary Lot. —Inspection, assembly, and the loading of unassembled igniter parts submitted as part of the preliminary lot, and testing of all loaded igniters submitted with, or derived from, the preliminary lot will be conducted at loading or firing activities to be designated by the Bureau of Ordnance. The sample sizes used in all tests shall be as large as those required for an inspection lot. All tests described in section 4.3, in addition to any others that may be required, shall be performed on a preliminary lot.

4.1.4 Inspection Lots. —Inspection lots of igniters or component parts shall consist of units of product which have been manufactured or loaded in a single plant over a period of continuous production during which no significant changes in process have occurred, and in which homogeneity within the lot may reasonably be expected.

4.1.4.1 Size of Inspection Lot -- Inert Parts. —Inspection lots of inert parts shall contain a minimum of 1301 units. The exact size of each inspection lot shall be recorded by the Government Inspector.

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4.1.4.2 Size of Lot-Loaded Igniters. -An inspection lot of loaded igniters shall consist of 10,000 igniters or multiples thereof plus those required for destructive acceptance tests (ref paragraph 4.1.4). An accurate record shall be kept of the component parts used in assembly and loading of each lot of loaded igniters.

4.2 Inspection

4.2.1 Government Inspection. -See OP 400 paragraph 4.2

4.2.2 Contractor's Inspection. -See OP 400 paragraph 4.1

4.3 Test Procedures

4.3.1 Igniter Electrical Continuity and Resistance. -The loading activity shall testify that each igniter offered for acceptance or delivery has an electrical continuity between 0.70 and 1.30 ohms inclusive, and that the electrical resistance between the connected lead wires and any portion of the bared metal of the igniter case and cover is not less than 50,000 ohms. The equipment used in measuring igniter electrical continuity and resistance shall not subject the igniter circuit to more than 25 milliamperes and shall meet with the approval of the Bureau of Ordnance.

4.3.2 Acceptance Testing of the Igniter. -A sample shall be selected according to NAVORD OSTD 60 and subjected to the following required acceptance tests. After ten successive lots have been accepted as per NAVORD OSTD 60 using an AQL of 1.0 and the appropriate inspection, periodic testing of a sample from 1 lot of each 10 received for inspection, may be instituted. Should the sample fail the test using reduced inspection, the lot shall not be rejected but will require return to normal inspection to determine lot acceptability or rejection. Normal inspection shall remain in effect until ten more successive lots have been accepted.

4.3.2.1 Vibration Test. -The selected igniters shall be numbered consecutively and their respective electrical circuit resistances determined and recorded (See 3.3.1). Divide the sample into three approximately equal groups and position as follows:

Group 1 Axis vertical-plug down
Group 2 Axis vertical-plug up
Group 3 Axis horizontal-insulated terminal up

All igniters shall be secured in suitable fixtures and subjected to a

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vibration of 2200 cpm for 40 minutes using a vertical amplitude of .031 inch ± .002 inch peak to peak. After vibration the electrical resistance of the igniters shall again be measured and recorded.

4.3.2.1.1 Acceptance Criteria.—To pass the vibration test, none of the igniter circuits shall have been found to fall outside the resistance limits of 0.70 and 1.30 ohms inclusive and none of the igniters shall have fired.

4.3.2.2 Air Tightness Test.—The igniter sample after having been vibrated and checked for electrical continuity shall be subjected to the airtightness test. This test shall consist of placing the igniters in from 6 to 10 inches of fresh water, covers down. The air space above the water shall be evacuated to approximately 3 pounds per square inch below ambient atmospheric pressure for a minimum time of 1 minute. A wetting agent is permitted to lessen the adhesion of bubbles to the igniters. All such bubbles should be eliminated before judging the assemblies under test. A steady flow of bubbles indicates air leakage.

4.3.2.2.1 Acceptance Criteria.—Any igniter showing evidence of leakage shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.3.2.3 Igniter Functioning Test.—After the vibration and air tightness testing, the igniters shall be subjected to the igniter functioning test using NAVORD OSTD 80 (AQL of 1.0) and an upper limit of 22 milliseconds. This test consists of applying a d.c. firing current of 1.5 ± 0.15 amps at normal room temperature (70°F ± 10°) to the igniter squib circuit and recording the temperature and the functioning time in milliseconds. The igniter functioning time is that overall elapsed time between the closing of the electrical firing circuit and the time when the igniter cover moves off the case or when flame emerges from between the igniter case and cover. The method and apparatus used in measuring the igniter functioning time shall be approved by the Bureau of Ordnance and accurate to one millisecond. All fired igniters must be recorded as to identification numbers and case opening times. Firing of igniters shall continue until the number required by NAVORD OSTD 80 has been reached with case opening times of less than 40 milliseconds. It is possible that the record of this test will show that some of the igniters have case opening times of more than 40 milliseconds. Igniters in this category shall not be considered as units in the sample size as defined in NAVORD OSTD 80 but will be recorded separately. In case of failure of the test equipment to record properly, disregard the reading and substitute an igniter that has passed all the tests prior to the igniter functioning test.

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4.3.2.3.1 Igniter Functioning Test Evaluation. —Acceptance of the lot shall be based upon the conformance of the igniters tested with the following requirements:

(a) Igniters having a functioning time of more than 40 milliseconds shall not exceed 4% of the number of igniters required for the sample.

(b) All igniters tested shall have a functioning time of less than 85 milliseconds.

(c) All igniters shall fire unless it can be shown that the cause was attributable to some other than a defective squib or defective electrical leads inside the igniter case.

4.3.2.4 Extreme Temperature Functioning Test. —This test is for informational use and shall be performed on the first five production lots and on every tenth production lot thereafter. Select 40 igniters at random and temperature condition for a minimum of 2 hours. Condition one-half the sample at -65°F ± 3° and the other half at + 165°F ± 3°. While at these temperatures, fire the igniters with a d.c. firing current of 1.5 ± 0.15 amperes, record firing times and forward the test results to the Bureau of Ordnance.

4.3.2.5 Ballistic Performance Tests. —On each preliminary lot and thereafter when so directed by the Bureau of Ordnance, fifty (50) sample igniters chosen at random shall be shipped to a designated firing activity for the accomplishment of ballistic performance tests. Igniters shall be assembled in standard, service-type rocket motors, or in equivalent static firing motor assemblies, by the firing activity. Such loaded rocket motors shall be fired either statically or in the field as circumstances at the firing activity may dictate. Maximum pressure in the motor, ignition delay time, and such other pertinent firing data as may be obtainable shall be recorded for each round fired. Ballistic firing tests of the igniters may be included with acceptance firing tests of rocket propellant grains if considered practicable and desirable by the firing activity.

4.3.2.5.1 Acceptance Criteria. —To pass the ballistics firing test, each igniter shall give proper ignition of the rocket motor, and there shall be no misfire, hangfire, or other evidence of malfunction attributable solely to the igniter.

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4.3.3 Compaction Evaluation.—Igniters selected in accordance with 4.3.2 shall be subjected to a compaction examination prior to and after the vibration test. Units shall be identified and results recorded for informational use only. Noticeable deformation outward of the cover or the case bottom denotes over-compaction. Under-compaction is determined by squeezing the loaded igniter between the thumb and the two fingers of the same hand. The two fingers should be astride the plug, and the thumb in the approximate center of the case cover. Noticeable deformation inward of cover or case bottom denotes under-compaction.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging and Packing of Inert Parts.—Packaging and packing of inert parts of the igniter, by the contractor, for shipment to assembly plants shall be in accordance with commercial domestic regulations.

5.2 Packaging and Packing of Loaded Igniters.—Packaging and packing of loaded igniters for shipment shall consist of placing 72 igniters in Igniter Container Mk 8 Mod 0. BuOrd Dwg 656328, LD 267523.

5.3 Marking.—The exterior of each shipping container shall be correctly and legibly marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 and I.C.C. Regulations.

5.4 Igniter Data Card.—Data cards, 3 1/2 inches by 7 1/2 inches, made from commercial white cardboard and printed as shown in the form below shall be properly filled out for each lot of loaded igniters. One card shall be placed in the top of each igniter container and two shall accompany ballistic samples.

IGNITER MK 125 MOD 4 DATA CARD

MIL-I (NOrd)_____ Rev ___
Dwg No. _____ Rev ___
Loaded By _____
_____
Date _____
Month Year
Contract No. _____
Lot No. _____
No. in Box _____
No. in Prod Lot _____
Req No. _____

Components

	Manufacturer	Lot No.	Year Mfg.
Inert Parts			
Electric Squib			
Black Powder FFFG			
Magnesium Powder			

Remarks

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended Use.—Igniter Mk 125 Mod 4 is for use in 2.75 in. Rocket Motors.

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6.2 Ordering Data. —Procurement documents should specify the title, number and date of this specification.

6.3 Safety Regulations. —The loading, assembly, and handling of the igniter and the related explosive components thereof, covered by this specification, involve hazardous operations and therefore require the observance of suitable safety precautions. Use of this specification shall not be construed as to relieve the contractor or the manufacturer of responsibility for the safety of his operations. Listed on the following page are the minimum provisions which a contractor or manufacture of Igniter Mk 125 Mod 4 should observe in order to fulfill his responsibility for safety. At Bureau of Ordnance, Navy Department, and other Government plants, these provisions are mandatory. Such other warnings and precautions which affect the operational effectiveness or safety during use or loading of the Igniter Mk 125 Mod 4 are included in the detailed provisions of the Specification.

6.3.1 All loading operations should be conducted in a neat and orderly manner.

6.3.2 Proper care should be exercised at all times to protect personnel from accidents, fires, or explosions, and to limit damage to equipment and loading areas. In this connection, the following precautionary measures should be observed:

6.3.2.1 Keep only minimum quantities of explosives and completed or partially loaded parts present at each stage of operation.

6.3.2.2 Keep explosives and explosive parts in approved covered receptacles with covers in place when material is not being taken out of or being put into the receptacles. Where necessary, receptacles should be conductive to ground electrostatic charges.

6.3.2.3 Protect all operations from static charges by effectively grounding all machinery, equipment, and fixtures, and where necessary, by providing adequately grounded conductive coverings for floors, work benches, tables and worker's shoes.

6.3.2.4 Where necessary, suitable safety clothing, including footwear, gloves, goggles, respirators, and impregnated garments should be worn to protect against burns, poisoning and associated industrial hazards.

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6.3.2.5 Allow no fires or exposed sparking electrical equipment and little or no flammable material to be present in loading, handling, and storage spaces. Enforce proper "No Match" and "No Smoking" rules where necessary.

6.3.2.6 Enforce good housekeeping and policing methods throughout the loading and storage areas, including surroundings. Employ effective cleaning methods periodically to minimize the accumulation of explosive dust upon, and assure its removal from, floors, walls, ceilings, ledges, tables, benches, and equipment. Clean up any spilled material immediately.

6.3.2.7 Employ properly proportioned and properly located protective barricades, screens, or shields at all required points.

6.3.3 Safe equipment and methods should be utilized for transporting and handling explosives and loaded parts.

6.3.4 All explosives and completely or partially loaded items should be stored in suitable storage magazines located in accordance with the American Table of Distances (A.T.D.) and, while in process, they should be stored in safety lockers and chests, if in loading rooms, or in adequate ready or service magazines located in accordance with intraplant distances when outside of loading rooms.

6.3.5 The exposure of explosive materials and related parts should be so controlled as to minimize the absorption of moisture from the atmosphere or other sources during loading and handling operations.

6.3.6 Personnel handling the loaded igniters and related parts which affect functioning should, insofar as practicable, avoid using bare fingers or improper handling equipment in order to prevent damage, corrosion, or deterioration from perspiration or other contaminating deposits.

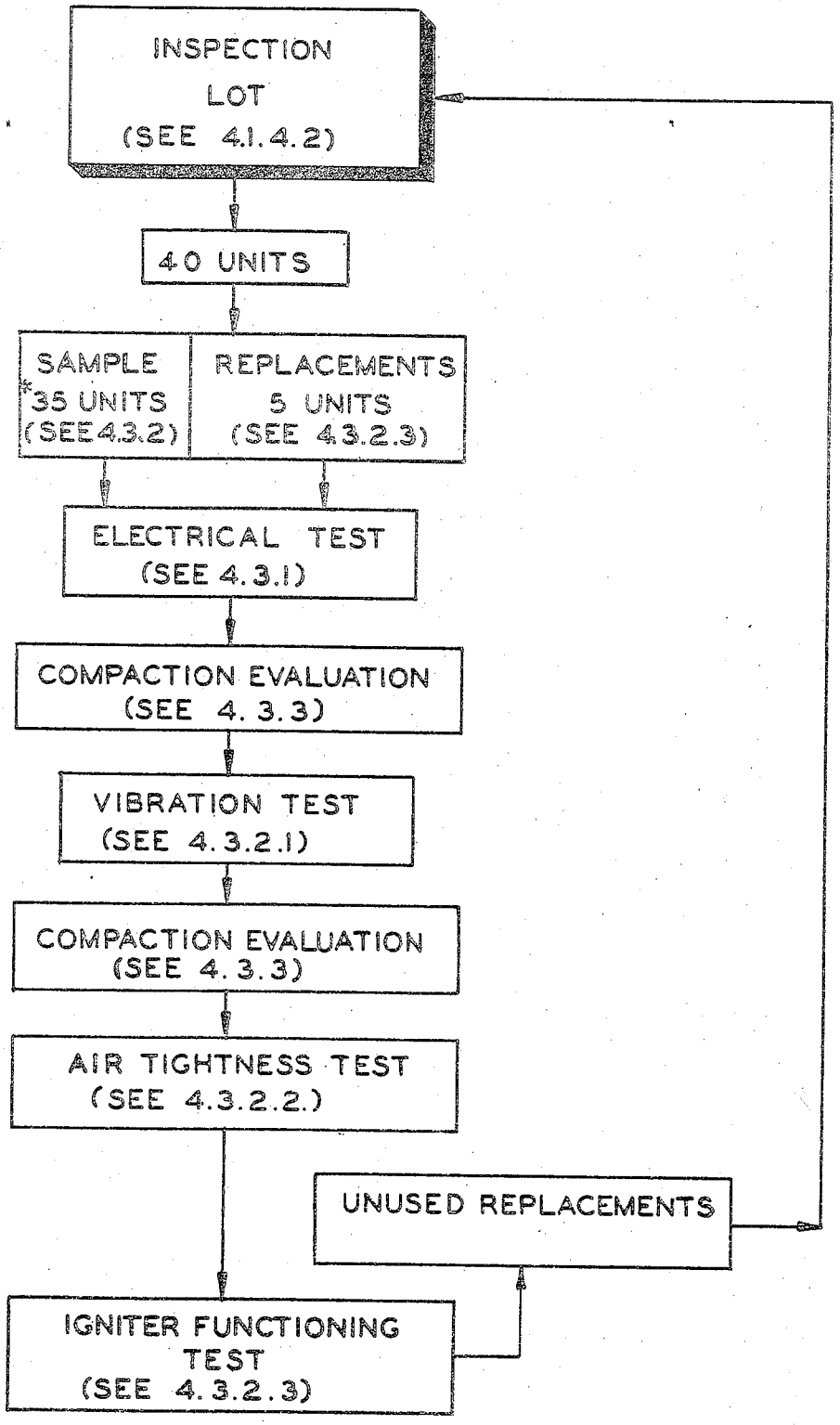
6.4 Patent Notice. --When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner

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INSPECTION FLOW CHART
DESTRUCTIVE TESTING



* Sample size based on reduced sampling

FIGURE 1

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